FAITH SHOULD NEVER REQUIRE GOVERNMENT PERMISSION

ADAM HAMDAN PROPOSES PROTECTIONS FOR RELIGIOUS ORGANIZATIONS FACING FEDERAL PRESSURE

BACON COUNTY, Ga. – Constitution Party presidential candidate Adam Hamdan returned to his hometown Saturday to introduce the First Amendment Protection Act, the religious-freedom section of his Secure Life, Secure Liberty program.

Hamdan announced the proposal outside Liberty Community Church, where volunteers were distributing food and supplies to local families.

Last year, the church applied for federal assistance to expand its food pantry. Pastor Elena Morris said church leaders became concerned after learning that conditions attached to the funding could affect how the organization selected employees for religious leadership positions.

"We serve every family that comes through our doors," Morris said. "But serving the public should not require our church to surrender control over its own religious leadership."

The church contacted Hamdan Law Firm for assistance. Hamdan and his legal team helped the organization challenge the conditions while keeping its food pantry open.

Hamdan said the experience showed how the government can use funding as leverage over private institutions.

"A church should not have to choose between feeding its community and remaining true to its faith," Hamdan said. "Religious freedom is a constitutional right, not a special favor from Washington."



Hamdan recently discussed the issue during an interview with Cali Turner on 104.7's Popular Callers.

"I believe that the freedom of religion cannot be infringed upon by the U.S. government," Hamdan told listeners. "The government has no authority to grant or deny religious expression."

THE PROPOSAL

Hamdan's First Amendment Protection Act would prevent federal agencies from using grants or tax policies to control a religious organization's doctrines, leadership, membership, or internal religious positions.

It would also preserve the tax-exempt status of churches and other qualifying religious organizations.

The proposal would apply to Christian, Jewish, Muslim, Hindu, Buddhist, and other religious organizations. Hamdan said it would also protect Americans who choose not to follow a religion.

ADDRESSING CIVIL-RIGHTS CONCERNS

Some critics worry that religious exemptions could weaken civil-rights protections. Hamdan said his proposal distinguishes between internal religious governance and services offered to the public.

Under his plan, a church food pantry would continue serving people regardless of their beliefs. However, the government could not force the church to select a pastor or religious leader who rejected its teachings. The proposal would not excuse violence, abuse, fraud, or violations of neutral public-safety laws.

"This is not a license to harm or discriminate against the public," Hamdan said. "It protects the right of peaceful religious organizations to govern their own religious affairs."

HAMDAN'S BACKGROUND

Born and raised in Bacon County, Hamdan studied criminal justice at Truett McConnell University before studying political science and finance at Stanford University. After serving in Afghanistan, he founded Hamdan Law Firm and began advocating for constitutional rights.

Hamdan later served two years in the Georgia House of Representatives and ran as the Constitution Party's vice-presidential candidate in 2024. He is now running for president alongside vice-presidential candidate David Jeon.

Hamdan, who is married and has three children, said independent churches, charities, schools,



and community organizations are an important part of American society.

"When government can pressure every independent institution into following the same beliefs, freedom loses its meaning," Hamdan said. "The Constitution limits government so that the people can remain free."

Adam Hamdan for President
David Jeon for Vice President
Paid for by the Hamdan-Jeon Campaign.

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